

Stop, retry, escalate

four failure classes, four deterministic responses

```
transient fault    -> retry      (RetryPolicy: bounded attempts)
impossible task    -> bounded loop (a hard recursion_limit)
missing info       -> clarify    (ask instead of guessing)
repeated failure   -> escalate   (a strikes counter hands off)
```

Three real langgraph runs below, one per policy.

Without policies: a transient fault crashes the run, an impossible task loops forever, and a repeated failure just hammers the same broken thing.